

SHAHID IQBAL

Full Stack Developer — Third-Party API Integration Specialist

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SUMMARY

Backend developer with hands-on experience connecting travel booking platforms to real, production third-party APIs across hotels, flights, cars, trains, and payments. I've integrated hotel supply APIs including **Travelpayouts**, **Hotelbeds**, **Wanderbeds**, **TourBMS**, and **RateHawk**, along with the **Duffel** flight API, the **Mozio** car API, and the **Xmoney** payment gateway (card and wallet payments), handling **authentication**, **data mapping**, and error handling so bookings and payments move reliably between the platform and outside services. I also built the backend API powering the company's mobile app. Core stack is **PHP** and **MySQL**, with working experience in **Laravel**, **PostgreSQL**, and JavaScript frameworks (**Vue.js/React**) on the frontend side.

EXPERIENCE

PHPTravels — Backend Developer *Lahore, Pakistan*

- Connected the **Travelpayouts** REST API using **token-based authentication**, parsing **JSON** hotel search, pricing, and availability responses and mapping supplier fields into the platform's internal hotel schema so users can search, compare, and complete hotel bookings.
- Integrated the **Hotelbeds** API as an additional hotel supply source, handling **API-key authentication** and **JSON** request/response cycles for search, pricing, and booking, and reconciling overlapping hotel content against the Travelpayouts feed to avoid duplicate listings.
- Integrated the **Wanderbeds** API for hotel search and booking, implementing **token-based authentication** and **JSON** data mapping to bring a new supplier's inventory and rates into the platform's existing pricing-comparison logic.
- Integrated the **RateHawk** API for hotel content, live pricing, and booking, normalizing supplier-specific **JSON** response structures into a consistent internal format so the booking flow could treat RateHawk inventory the same as other suppliers.
- Connected the **TourBMS** API to bring in additional hotel and tour inventory, handling **API-key authentication**, **JSON** data exchange, and field-level mapping so TourBMS content plugged into the same booking pipeline as other suppliers.
- Connected the **Duffel** REST API using **token-based authentication** so users can search flights in real time, book tickets, and manage flight bookings after purchase, parsing **JSON** offer and order responses into the platform's flight booking flow.
- Implemented **webhook listeners** for booking status updates (confirmations, cancellations, changes) from supplier APIs, updating booking records in real time instead of relying on polling.
- Connected the **Mozio** API so users can search for and book cars/car rides through the platform, handling **JSON** request/response cycles for availability and pricing.
- Connected a train booking API that lets users search and book train tickets for rail networks in Jakarta and China, mapping route, schedule, and fare data into the platform's booking system.
- Built the backend API for the PHPTravels mobile app — handling user login/session authentication, **JSON** data exchange between the app and main system, and making sure requests stayed fast and reliable on mobile networks.
- Integrated the **Xmoney** payment gateway to process card and wallet-based payments for bookings, handling **API-key/token authentication**, **JSON** request/response cycles, and payment status confirmation before finalizing bookings.
- Set up **API-key/token authentication** for each supplier connection and validated that **JSON** data returned by each API was parsed, sanitized, and stored correctly before reaching the booking flow.
- Found and fixed errors across API connections and backend code — including malformed supplier responses, timeout handling, and edge cases in booking status transitions — to keep bookings running without breaking.
- Worked closely with frontend and mobile teams to keep the booking process consistent across website and app, aligning on request/response contracts for each supplier integration.

- Kept backend systems fast and efficient as more supplier APIs and **webhook listeners** were added over time, watching for bottlenecks as integration count grew.

Kingtower — Web Developer Intern *Lahore, Pakistan*

- Built responsive websites using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript that worked well on both desktop and mobile screens.
- Worked with the design team to turn designs into real, working web pages that were easy for users to navigate.
- Regularly tested the website and fixed bugs to keep everything working correctly for users.
- Took part in code reviews with the team, learning and following good coding habits and best practices.
- Wrote simple guides and notes about how things were built, so other team members could pick up the work easily.

KEY PROJECTS

Skyvela — Unified Travel Booking Platform

Stack: PHP, MySQL, REST APIs (Travelpayouts, Hotelbeds, Duffel, Mozio)

- Designed and built the backend layer that merges hotel, flight, and car rental supplier APIs into a single searchable, **bookable system**, instead of users having to check each supplier separately.
- Built a normalization layer that maps each supplier's **JSON** response into one consistent internal data model, so the frontend can render hotel, flight, and car results the same way regardless of which API they came from.
- Handled cross-supplier booking logic — a single checkout can create bookings against multiple supplier APIs (e.g. a hotel via **Hotelbeds** and a car via **Mozio**) and track each booking's status independently.
- Implemented **webhook handling** so booking status changes from any connected supplier update the unified booking record in real time.

Umrah Travel Booking System

Stack: PHP, MySQL

- Built a dedicated booking system for **Umrah pilgrimage packages**, separate from the general hotel/flight flow, to handle package-specific data like itinerary, group size, and package tiers.
- Designed the **database schema** for package selection, pilgrim details, and booking status tracking across the lifecycle of a pilgrimage booking.
- Built admin-facing tools for managing package availability and reviewing/updating customer bookings.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Software Engineering — Gomal University

Jul 2025 | Dera Ismail Khan, Pakistan — GPA 3.72, Top 10% of class

SKILLS

- **Languages & Frameworks:** PHP, Laravel, JavaScript, Vue.js, React
- **Databases:** MySQL, PostgreSQL
- **Travel API Integrations:** Travelpayouts, Hotelbeds, Wanderbeds, RateHawk, TourBMS, Duffel, Mozio
- **Payment Integrations:** Xmoney (card & wallet payments)
- **API & Backend:** RESTful API Integration, API Authentication, Data Mapping, **Webhooks**, Backend Architecture, Server-Side Programming
- **Other:** Database Management, Code Documentation, Performance Optimization, Team Collaboration, Problem Solving, HTML/CSS